

KOFTA - FRAGRANT LAMB MEATBALLS

INGREDIENTS

1/4 cup each pine nuts, almonds, and walnuts (total 3/4 cup)
1/2 cup breadcrumbs
1 small yellow onion, roughly chopped
3 cloves garlic, roughly chopped
1 small red bell pepper, roughly chopped
1 small jalapeño pepper, seeds and ribs removed, roughly chopped
1/2 cup cilantro leaves, gently packed (okay to substitute parsley)
900gms ground lamb
3/4 teaspoon ground cumin
Heaping 1/4 teaspoon ground cinnamon
Heaping 1/4 teaspoon ground cardamom
Heaping 1/4 teaspoon ground cloves
1-1/2 teaspoons salt
1/4 teaspoon white pepper
Tzatziki and hummus, for serving

METHOD

- 1. Toast the nuts:** Pulse **nuts** in a **food processor** until finely chopped, then transfer to a dry skillet. Toast over **medium heat**, stirring, until fragrant (**5–6 minutes**). Cool in a mixing bowl.
- 2. Prepare the vegetables:** Pulse **onion, garlic, bell pepper, jalapeño, and cilantro** until finely minced. Wring out excess liquid using a clean dishcloth, then add to the bowl with nuts.
- 3. Mix the kofta:** Combine **lamb, cumin, cinnamon, cardamom, cloves, salt, and white pepper** with the nut mixture. Mash with hands until evenly blended.
- 4. Shape & chill:** Form into patties, place on a **baking sheet**, cover, and refrigerate until ready to cook.
- 5. Grill:** Preheat to **medium-high**, oil the grates, and cook **4 minutes per side**, covered, until browned and cooked through.
- 6. Serve:** Enjoy with **tzatziki and hummus**.

THE
COOKERY

by The Secret Jozi Chef